

# SST Innovation Lab — Pre-Lab Alignment Call

Monday May 18, 11:00 AM CDT | 30 minutes | Andrew McKnight + Elizabeth (VP FP&A;) + Randall Dunigan + Diana Stevens

## SITUATION

SST has engaged Improving for up to 5 Innovation Labs across their org. **Lab 1 is confirmed May 26** at SST's Dallas office — audience is Elizabeth (VP FP&A;) and her team. You and Randall are co-facilitating. This call locks in the group-specific evaluation criteria so use case scoring on the day is meaningful.

## PEOPLE ON THE CALL

| Person          | Role                       | Notes                                                |
|-----------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Andrew McKnight | SST — champion             | Organized this call, confirmed May 26                |
| Elizabeth       | SST — VP FP&A              | Client for this lab — her team are the participants  |
| Randall Dunigan | Improving — co-facilitator | Less familiar with lab material — you're guiding him |
| Diana Stevens   | Improving — VP Sales       | Relationship owner                                   |

## WHAT THIS CALL IS FOR

1. **Align on evaluation criteria** — how does FP&A; define value? Time, cost, headcount, accuracy?
2. **Understand the team** — who's in the room, AI literacy, any skeptics?
3. **Pre-workshop worksheet** — sent yet? When? Who sends it?
4. **Confirm logistics** — address, start time, materials
5. **Set Randall up** — give him what he needs to be a confident co-facilitator

## QUESTIONS TO ASK

### Team & context:

- “Elizabeth — how many folks on your team, and where would you say they fall on AI awareness?”
- “Any areas you want us to focus use case exploration on, or let it emerge from the worksheet?”

### Evaluation criteria:

- “What are the 2-3 metrics that matter most when your team evaluates an idea? Time, cost, headcount, accuracy?”
- “Anything that would be a non-starter — areas we should steer the group away from?”

### Logistics:

- “Can you confirm address and start time for May 26?”
- “Has the pre-workshop worksheet gone out? If not, best way to get it to the team this week?”

## LISTEN FOR

- Elizabeth's enthusiasm — voluntold vs. bought-in shapes how you open the room
- Pain points she names — forecasting, reporting cycles, variance analysis are rich FP&A; territory
- Andrew as sponsor vs. logistics — if he's delegating, make sure Elizabeth is driving
- Appetite to schedule Labs 2–5 — if they want all done by year-end, open that door

## WORKSHOP AGENDA — MAY 26 (8:00 AM – 4:30 PM)

| Time       | Phase                           | Topics                                                                                               |
|------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8:00–12:15 | Morning — Learn & Explore       | Welcome & framing, AI foundations, FP&A case studies, pain point mapping, opportunity identification |
| 1:00–3:15  | Afternoon — Create & Prioritize | Use case brainstorming, scoring (impact vs. effort), Use Case 1 breakdown                            |
| 3:15–4:30  | Late Afternoon — Wrap           | Use Cases 2 & 3 breakdowns, feedback, deliverables preview                                           |

Evaluation criteria locked today feeds the scoring session at ~2:15 PM.